

# THE BANK ALFALAH EXPERIENCE CENTER

## *Prototype Challenge*

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### The Brief

Bank Alfalah wants to reimagine what a branch of the future looks like. Not a branch — an **Experience Center**: a single physical space where any customer — a student opening their first account, a business owner applying for a loan, a retiree managing their savings, a family buying their first home — can walk in and have every banking need met in one visit, with an experience that feels **more like a flagship store than a bank**. But beyond design, Bank Alfalah now has one critical question: Is this even feasible as a scalable, profitable banking model?

Your team has been hired to design this space. Your team must create a visual concept for the experience center's digital interface - what a customer sees on the screens inside the center, or what the center's app/kiosk interface looks like. You may use:

- AI image generation tools (ChatGPT, Midjourney, Claude, Canva AI etc.) to create visuals of the space or UI screens.
- Any design or presentation tool on your phone or laptop to create a simple mock-up, infographic or concept board.

This does NOT need to be a working app - it needs to be your team's vision for the digital experience inside the center. Remember: Quality of thinking matters more than design polish.

In addition to the above, you also need to evaluate whether your prototype can realistically work in the real world. At the end, you will pitch your design to the Bank Alfalah leadership team as if you are presenting to the CEO.

### What Your Digital Model Must Include

Your physical prototype must clearly show the following five zones:

#### 1. The Welcome Zone — First 30 Seconds

- How does a customer feel the moment they walk in? What do they see, hear, and experience?
- Think: digital welcome screen that recognizes returning customers, greeter with a tablet, ambient branding, accessibility features for all customers.

#### 2. The Self-Service Hub — Instant Banking

- A zone where customers can handle routine transactions without waiting in a queue.
- Think: smart ATMs/CDMs, account opening kiosks (CNIC-based, 3-minute process), Raast transfers, bill payments, card issuance on the spot.

#### 3. The Advisory Lounge — Conversations, Not Counters

- A space where customers sit with a relationship manager for complex needs — loans, investments, insurance, business banking.
- Think: private consultation pods (not open desks), screens showing the customer's portfolio, digital document signing, family-friendly options.

#### 4. The Digital Experience Wall — Wow Factor

- An interactive zone that showcases Bank Alfalah's digital products: the Alfa app, Alfa Business, Roshan Digital Accounts, investment tools.
- Think: touchscreens where customers can explore products, a live demo station, QR codes linking to app features, an AI financial health checker.

## The Feasibility and Operational Model

Your team must now design a Feasibility Layer answering the following:

### 1. Financial Feasibility

- What would it cost to build 1 Experience Center?
- What would monthly operating costs look like?
- What revenue streams justify it?

### 2. Customer Feasibility

- Who will actually use this?
- Which segments benefit most vs least?
- Will traditional banking customers adopt it?

### 3. Operational Feasibility

- Staff required per shift
- Training needs (especially for hybrid advisory roles)
- Technology dependency risks
- Peak-hour handling strategy

### 4. Scalability Logic

- Can this be replicated across Pakistan?
- How would the design change between a major city (e.g. Karachi, Lahore) and a smaller city (Sukkur, Abbottabad)?
- Standardized vs customizable elements

## Timeline

| Phase                         | Duration | What Happens                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Individual Reading            | 3 min    | Read this document. Ask questions. Clarify anything you don't understand.                                                                                                                                                             |
| Strategy & Planning           | 5 min    | Discuss your concept as a team. Decide zones, and what the customer journey could potentially look like.                                                                                                                              |
| Design + Feasibility Strategy | 20 min   | Create your digital model AND develop your feasibility logic                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Final Pitch                   | 12 min   | Each team presents their Experience Center to the assessors. Walk us through the customer journey: "Imagine you are a customer walking into our Bank Alfalah Experience Center..." Show the digital model as well as the feasibility. |

### REMEMBER

You are not just building a model — you are designing an experience.

Think about what makes people choose one bank over another. It's not the interest rate. It's how the bank makes them feel.

The best Experience Center is the one that makes a customer say: "I want to come back here."

***Good luck. Build something worth visiting.***

